

tables

The `tables` property is private and, thus, shouldn't be accessed directly, if at all. The property contains an array of the table names that are used by WordPress.

field_types

The `field_types` property is new in WordPress 2.8. It contains an array of field names where you can specify what character type (integer or string) to return field data as. This is set in `wpsettings.php`, but can be re-declared in a plugin function that hooks into the `init` action hook.

charset

Like the table properties, the `charset` property stores the character set of the database itself, which is generally UTF-8. The `charset` property is unlikely to be used often in WordPress plugin development.

collate

Similar to the `charset` property, the `collate` property holds the collation value for the database. It is unlikely to be used often in WordPress plugin development.

real_escape

The final property available in the database class, the `real_escape` property, instructs WordPress on whether to use the `mysql_real_escape_string()` function. The function is set to `false` by default because data sanitization is handled elsewhere in WordPress, making the need for this property unlikely.

8.3 Adding Data to MySQL with WordPress

Two main API methods are used to add data to MySQL: `insert()` and `update()`. These methods take care of sanitizing and preparing all data for insertion or updating MySQL from within WordPress. For the sake of backward compatibility, WordPress waits a long time before removing functions, classes, methods and, in this case, table name properties from the core. This is because plugin authors, in many cases, try to build plugins that will work on any version that has been released. When WordPress 2.3 was released, it introduced the concept of tags when before, the only metadata available for posts was in the form of categories. During those days, there were a number